became an inevitable trend as the Indian environment influenced these people from the north-west and absorbed them. While the process continued at the top, more powerful currents arose spontaneously among the people, aiming at a synthesis of thought and ways of living. The beginnings of a mixed culture began to appear and foundations were laid on which Akbar was to build.

Akbar was the third of the Mughal dynasty in India, yet it was in effect by him that'the empire was consolidated. His grandfather, Babai, had won the throne of Delhi in **1526,** but he was **a stranger** to India and continued to feel so. He had come from the **north,** where **the** Timurid Renaissance was flourishing in his

homelands in central Asia and the influence of the art and culture of Iran was strong. He missed the friendly-society he was used to, the delights of conversation, the amenities and refinements of | life which had spread from Baghdad and Iran. He longed for the snow and ice of the northern highlands, for the good flesh and flowers and fruits of Ferghana. Yet, with all his disappointment at what he saw, he says that Hindustan is a remarkably fine country. Babar died within four years of his coming to India, and much